Lavender Haze

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/53147143.

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Explicit

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
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by Asphyxia

Summary

Catra and Adora are ready to take their relationship to the next level but neither of them know exactly how to proceed. With a little advice from their friends and a night away from the rest of the Rebellion, the two of them find a way to connect for the first time. (fluffy Catradora first time fic)

Notes

This is my fourth Catradora smut fic written in honor of Adora's birthday, as it's become a tradition :) I had a lot of fun writing this one as I've never really gotten to write a proper, fluffy first time fic for them before. Usually my smutty fics are over the top and idealized but I wanted to write something a little more grounded with that awkward nervousness that comes along with the reality of actually having lesbian sex for the first time because realistically, none of us know what to do the first time and that is okay.

I chose to use it/its pronouns for Melog this time because those are what the characters use on the show. I tend to default to they/them for Melog but upon rewatching the show closely to get a better grasp on the characters' speech patterns for the fic I remembered all over again that it/its are actually the only pronouns anyone uses for Melog, oops!

Happy birthday, Adora!

“I want you.”

It was just three simple words in that familiar voice, but it cut through Adora’s concentration so completely, so thoroughly that her hands completely froze on the hunk of metal shrapnel she was preparing to lift. Straightening back up, she turned to find her girlfriend standing behind her.

Despite the confident and somewhat amused smirk on Catra’s face, her cheeks were a faint shade of pink even through her fur. Adora had to clear her throat several times before her voice stopped failing her.

“Huh?”

“I think you heard me.” Catra replied with the confidence only someone who had just made the first move could hope to express. In that moment, she was a force to be reckoned with.

Adora had heard her, of course. But there was nothing stopping her from assuming maybe the soft sound of chirping birds or distant voices of the other Rebellion members who were also participating in cleaning up the damage done by Horde Prime were somehow drowning out Catra’s voice enough that she’d misheard.

“Maybe. But I uh…well. Did you say…?”

“Yeah.”

Of course, Catra and Adora wanted each other. It was something that was as obvious as anything ever had been, and it was something clear to even people who had barely seen the two of them interact. But the purposefulness behind the way she said it was what set Adora off. The implication, something that strayed beyond the more innocent meaning of the word ‘want’. The mere thought made her mouth dry.

It had been nearly a month since the two of them confessed their love at the Heart and saved the universe with their first kiss. In the days and weeks that stretched onward from there with the two of them forging a new and ever developing relationship they'd had no shortage of further kisses, sometimes inching bravely further into unknown territory on nights when they felt bold, but so far beyond kisses and hands that strayed over clothed bodies, the couple hadn't actually *done* anything.

But Adora had thought about it. In fact, she'd spent the better part of the afternoon distracted thinking about it after a particularly dizzying makeout session the night before. She swore she could still feel Catra's hands on her hips, her palm on her chest. Her touch was burned into her skin even through her clothes in a way she would never forget.

Somewhere nearby, Mermista and Perfuma were arguing about something, and their voices carrying over the wind shook Adora back to reality where she found herself simply starting blankly at her girlfriend. She cleared her throat again.

"So did you mean like…" it was harder to get the words out than it had been to form them in her head, and Adora was embarrassed about tripping over them like this. Catra was her girlfriend. They should be able to talk about this subject like adults. And yet, somehow no other words would come out and she just opened and then closed her mouth. In spite of the coolness of the spring breeze, Adora's cheeks blazed so hot she'd swear they were on fire if she didn't know any better.

"I mean sex, yeah." Catra said it bluntly in a way that was so impressive but also simultaneously so embarrassing that Adora had to take a moment to breathe. The two of them were alone in the particular clearing they'd been ridding of Prime bot debris and for a moment it felt that they were alone on Etheria as well. The rest of the world seemed to stop. "If you don't want to that's okay. We don't have to do anything you're not into. I just thought I'd put it out there since last night was…a lot."

Adora nodded enthusiastically. "No! I mean…no I don't not want to! I mean I do want to! Sorry." once again, words were failing her miserably. "I wanna do that. I just…wanted to be sure that was what you were getting at."

The fondness on Catra's face melted Adora's heart. "Of course it was what I was getting at, dummy. If it wasn't I wouldn't have said it. You already know I want you every other way."

"Well yeah." Adora's dry mouth managed to produce even the two simple words clumsily. She wondered if Catra understood what a profound effect she had on her. "So when did you want to…?"

"I was thinking tonight. That work for you?"

"Sure!" Adora blurted it out with more enthusiasm than she meant to, but the wider smile and increased pinkness on Catra's face told her it was probably for the best. "That…sounds great!"

"So, your tent or mine?" Catra asked her playfully. The Rebellion had taken to staying several days at a time in whatever area of Etheria they were working on ridding of debris left over from the war. It was the first stage of the longterm Etheria restoration plan. At each location they would set up a camp of the standard issue Bright Moon military tents with the standard issue Bright Moon military cots. Adora found herself shaking her head. Despite spending most of her life sleeping in a military setting and not really caring much about her surroundings, something about the idea of spending their first night together in a military tent felt so…unromantic somehow.

"I want to go back to Bright Moon," Adora told her girlfriend. She could feel her own smile soften. "I want our first time to be at home. In our bed."

"Well, I guess I can't ever say romance is dead," Catra replied lightheartedly, but her eyes were infinitely soft. Infinitely soft. The way she was looking at Adora could probably end wars. If someone told Adora Catra would look at her like this after three

years of facing each other on the battlefield, she wouldn't have believed them. But somehow, against all odds, here they were. "Should we be holding off then?"

"Swift Wind can take us back tonight."

"Won't he ask questions? I'm assuming you don't wanna explain to your horse you'll be having sex."

"He might. But I don't have to answer."

Catra nodded, and the way she looked at Adora then, with a kind of *heat* she could barely even withstand the power of…it almost made her reconsider. Maybe a tent was fine, as long as she didn't have to wait another minute. The impulse to grab her by the hand and drag her back to camp was overwhelming. A vivid memory of the heat of Catra's mouth on hers the night before in Adora's tent flashed through her mind, the two of their bodies pressed so close together on the cot that it made her feel like she was going insane. Just the memory of it made her heart pound and she wet her lips with the tip of her tongue.

For a brief second the idea of just pushing Catra up against a tree didn't seem so crazy, but the sound of approaching voices snapped Adora back to reality. When Spinnerella and Netossa appeared in the gaps between the trees, she and Catra both stepped back from each other as though they'd been caught doing something intimate instead of only talking about it.

"Catra, Adora! There you are. We're all gonna break for lunch. You coming?" Netossa asked.

Adora glanced at Catra, who was smirking slightly and upon realizing it was likely because of the word choice she found herself flushing. 'Not until tonight', she couldn't help thinking and then applauding her own internal cheekiness.

"Yeah, sure!" Adora had most definitely not been thinking about her normal everyday needs and the fact that she was hungry had somehow managed to escape her entirely. Conveniently her

stomach chose that moment to growl loudly, and Spinnerella laughed.

"King Micah roasted some meat and Perfuma and I are going to whip up some vegetable platters," the older princess told Adora as the two of them fell into step beside each other. "It should only take a second."

"Why is it always vegetable platters with you?" Netossa asked her wife.

"They're healthy," Spinnerella pointed out. "We have protein from the meat and we need the vitamins from the vegetables. We've all been working hard today. We need complete nourishment. Even if *some* of us would eat nothing but steak and potatoes every day if we didn't have a wife to make sure we ate a balanced diet."

"That's not true and you know it." Netossa was attempting to sound cross, but she was grinning at her wife.

"I guess I was being unfair." For a moment, Spinnerella looked chastened, but then a smirk appeared on her face. "Sometimes you eat chicken nuggets too I guess."

"Shut up!" Netossa was laughing, but she elbowed her wife playfully. "I'll eat your vegetable platters if it'll make you happy but you can't read me to filth like that."

"Sorry," Spinnerella said sweetly, but the grin on her face made it obvious she wasn't actually sorry.

As the two wives continued to playfully tease each other Catra caught Adora's eye. She was relieved to see Catra looked as nervous and excited as she felt. Catra smiled at her and it was like all of Etheria disappeared again except her.

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With a new goal at its end, the day seemed to tick by slower and slower. What had begun as a normal day of Etherian restoration work had spiraled into what seemed to be an endless nightmare and to Adora it seemed to pass slower and slower with each minute that she was able to struggle through. Several times she found herself looking at her watch only to remember she didn't wear one.

There was always more debris to pick up, more things to distract her, but though the endless moments weren't empty, they were excruciating. Etheria's moons crept so slowly in their daily cycle overhead that Adora wanted to scream. Though her body went through the motions of the objectively important work of repairing Etheria, her mind was with Catra and Catra alone. Each time they made eye contact with each other in passing, Catra would wink at her in a way that drove her insane and left her in shambles. It was cruel, and she wondered if Catra knew it.

"Hey Adora," she whispered in one particularly agonizing passing as she brushed her fingertips down the full length of Adora's arm, and it was in that moment Adora understood that Catra knew she was torturing her. That she was doing it on purpose. And it only served to make the afternoon move slower.

As the day wore on, Adora did her best to stay distracted. She chatted idly with Bow while she worked, she transformed into She-ra and helped Frosta with some particularly heavy detritus, she helped deliver water to the Rebellion members who were scattered further out in the forest.

If she let her mind wander too much she could feel her heart starting to pound, her body starting to heat up. Adora liked to think she at least had enough discipline to avoid getting noticeably horny at work, but it was increasingly difficult not to think about the fact that tonight she was going to be with Catra for the first time. She was momentarily pleased when she made a compromise with herself that she would only let herself think of the logistics of the night, to let herself come up with a concrete

war plan. Only momentarily. Because in the process she realized she had absolutely no idea how to actually go about having sex.

"Is it something that people just know how to do by instinct?" she asked herself out loud, pausing halfway back to the designated dumping pile for bot scrap that would later be taken to the Fright Zone's foundry and melted into useable parts for repairs. "Will *I* just know what to do? I mean I guess I know the basics but…" by this point she dropped the scrap she was hauling in favor of pacing back and forth along the forest floor. In She-ra form, she quickly wore a trough into the grass.

"I could write it down, I guess? But that just sounds stupid. Ugh, come on! Can't being She-ra have some benefit like…I don't know…all of the knowledge of the known universe or something so I don't have to go into this without a clue about what to do?" when she kicked the dropped bot debris the loud clang echoed out through the woods and several birds in a nearby tree scattered dramatically.

"Who are you talking to?" Glimmer's voice held a barely concealed giggle.

"Uh…"

"Is everything okay? It looked like you were yelling at the sky." Being friends with Glimmer meant dealing with her appearing at random with no warning, but in Adora's current state there was no telling whether she'd done so or if she'd just walked up like a normal person and Adora had simply failed to even notice.

"Huh? Oh yeah. Sure." Immediately flustered someone had caught her like this, Adora quickly picked the debris back up and tried to act natural. "I was just…"

"Yelling to yourself in the middle of the forest?"

"I mean…technically, yeah."

“I could hear you from over by the scrap heap. What’s going on? What’s wrong?” Glimmer’s amused expression softened. “Are you okay?”

“Oh, yeah! Totally. I just…”

“You just what?”

“I don’t know. Well…”

“What?”

“It’s embarrassing so I…”

“You don’t wanna talk about it here.” Glimmer never failed to know Adora better than she knew herself, and she found herself nodding. Before she could even speak again Glimmer was grabbing her by the arm and in a whirlwind of sparkles the two of them stood beside the dumping site. Adora tossed the hunk of scrap into the pile but it barely had time to leave her hands before the two were in Glimmer’s tent, the bright bustle of the woods gone and replaced by quiet privacy. The shorter princess plopped down on her cot and patted the space beside her.

“Okay,” Glimmer told her in a soft voice. “Everybody should be off working right now, so nobody is around. What’s wrong?”

“Well um…” Adora sat down beside Glimmer and immediately began to fidget. The idea of unexpectedly having to put her plight into words was a daunting one, but at least it was just Glimmer. Glimmer had seen Adora at her best and her worst and everything in between and if there was anyone she could possibly feel anything even close to comfortable confiding in about this, it was her.

“It’s okay. Whatever it is, we’ll figure it out together, okay?”

Adora’s shoulders loosened somewhat. “Well. Catra and I are gonna…you know. Sex?”

The concern on Glimmer's face melted away and turned into amusement. "You're gonna sex?"

"If you're not gonna take this seriously then I'll just leave."

"Sorry, sorry!" Glimmer giggled a bit and then placed a hand on her shoulder. "Go ahead. You and Catra are going to have sex. So what's the problem?"

"Well. I don't really know how to actually. You know. Do that."

Glimmer's expression softened once more and she squeezed Adora's shoulder gently. "You mean like you don't physically know how, or are you just nervous?"

"What do you mean?" Adora was momentarily stunned.

"I mean…do you not know about what to do biologically? Like, anatomically? Or are you just awkward figuring out how to go through with it? Like, do you know what sex would look like? With the two of you's you know…anatomy?" Glimmer was clearly trying to make this as painless as possible but it was still excruciating. At least Glimmer looked a little embarrassed too. This question at least gave Adora pause. It tripped her up enough that she had to stop and think and it reset her racing mind a bit.

"Well, biologically I know what to do I guess. But just like…I don't know, ugh! Sure I know what to do, in a sense. Like… hypothetically. But there's two of us. So what if she does something and I don't know how to respond? Or if I do something and she doesn't like it? Or if I mess up somehow? How am I even supposed to plan for something like this? I tried making a diagram for what I wanna do in my head but I ended up getting stuck right away. Do people…do people normally plan it out?"

"I don't think they do," Glimmer answered her simply, and it was a shot to her pride. "I think…well. Look. I think it's normal to be nervous, or to not be able to visualize how you're going to do every step of the entire night. Not everything is going to be like a battle plan, Adora. You can't really plan for every eventuality like

you would in the war room. It's okay to just let things happen naturally."

Of course Adora knew this was objectively good advice. But as good as she'd gotten at improvising, the idea of leaving something this important up to chance was terrifying in a way she didn't exactly know how to verbalize. Instead, she clenched and unclenched her fists in her lap and was surprised when Glimmer's hands came to rest on top of them. Somehow such a small gesture was enough to relax her.

"What if I'm awful at it?" Adora heard herself ask. "What if she regrets asking me at all?"

"Well…" Glimmer paused for a moment and squeezed her hands. "If you're bad at it, then you'll get better eventually. You don't have to be good at it. It's about being together, you know? The first time Bow and I did it it was kind of a disaster, honestly. But it was still nice. Being able to connect in that way. What matters is that you communicate, and then everything will work itself out eventually."

Somehow, the thought of Bow and Glimmer having sex was more embarrassing than her current predicament, and it distracted her enough that she calmed down. "So you and Bow…?"

"Yeah. We um…didn't wait very long at all. After how close we came to losing each other there didn't seem like there was a point in holding back anymore. As soon as we were able to get a little privacy after you defeated Prime we couldn't hold it together anymore. We talked about everything and we cried in each other's arms and it just sort of…happened. We came so close to never seeing each other again. To losing everything. So it just felt right."

"Yeah I…know the feeling. I guess I just didn't really know how to uh…bring it up to Catra, you know?"

"Well, the important thing is the two of you waited until you were ready and comfortable, right? Everybody goes at their own pace.

You've got the rest of your lives to figure it out. It doesn't matter how it goes or if it ends up being a total mess. You'll have a million more chances. I know you don't like hearing this Adora, but you don't always have to be perfect at everything."

"I know, I know." Adora waved the words away with a flippant gesture. "Thanks, Glimmer."

"How do you feel now?"

"Um. Still nervous beyond belief. But thanks. For talking me through it."

"Any time. So when is the alleged magical night happening?"

"Tonight. We're gonna have Swift Wind take us back to the palace."

"I could take you instead if you want. I'm sure you don't wanna have this conversation with Swift Wind."

"That would be great. Thanks, Glimmer. It'd be a lot easier than coming up with some excuse for why we're running off to Swift Wind."

"No problem. Catra doesn't even have to know we had this conversation. I won't say a word, I promise."

"Thanks. I feel like Catra would probably laugh if she knew I had to ask for advice."

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Under the canopy of the trees deeper into the forest, Catra let herself pace back and forth in a straight line at the base of a massive willow. Being out of sight of Adora was much easier than

having to feign confidence and ease when the night crept closer and closer.

Initially, when she'd plucked up the courage to ask Adora, it was easy to remain cool and collected. She had the upper hand, the deck was stacked in her favor. She'd made the first move and so as soon as she'd been able to escape her natural fear of rejection enough to actually come out and ask Adora about taking things the next step, actually talking about it hadn't been scary at all.

The truth was Catra knew Adora wouldn't reject her, deep down. Not after the desperation in her kisses the night before, the way her hands lingered on Catra's chest for probably a bit longer than she meant for them to before her murmured apology. But even when it went against logic, when it came down to it Catra went so off the rails over the agony of any perceived rejection that putting herself in any kind of vulnerable position was terrifying in a way anyone else would never understand. But for Catra, Adora was worth it. She was worth battling her demons enough to allow herself the vulnerability and potential for humiliation, just for the chance to get closer to her every time they overcame a new hurdle together.

Catra knew she'd made the right choice taking the first step. Adora wasn't shy by any means, but she was never good about asking for what she wanted or even always *understanding* what she wanted. Catra however understood what Adora wanted perfectly, and since their wants lined up exactly, she hadn't been content with just waiting around for Adora to make the first move.

The only problem was that now that things were moving forward, she was so nervous that she was jittery and on edge and snapping at every person she came into contact with. By now, people were starting to avoid her.

"Woah there Catra, watch your step there!"

Of course, except for Scorpia, who unfortunately lacked the common sense to stay away from Catra when Catra didn't deserve

to even be given the time of day by someone so kind. Even when Catra had just come dangerously close to beaning her with a sheet of mangled metal, Scorpia was kind.

“Sorry.” Apologies came easier and easier the more time passed after the end of the war, especially to Scorpia. Catra owed her a billion apologies but more than one for each thing slid from genuine remorse to simple self-indulgence, so she tended to keep most of it to herself. “I didn’t mean to hit you. You okay?”

“You missed me,” Scorpia assured her, dropping the Prime bot she was holding over her shoulder onto the ground to show that her body didn’t have a scratch. “Something on your mind today? You seem a little…”

“Bitchy?” Catra asked, and Scorpia sweated a bit.

“Well, I’d never use that word. But…unhappy, maybe? Or grouchy?”

“Sorry.” Catra sighed. “I guess I’ve got a lot on my mind.”

“Ooh, like what?”

“I can’t tell you.”

“Aww. Why not?” Scorpia asked, and Catra gritted her teeth.

“Scorpia… no offense. But because you can’t keep a secret for five minutes and I don’t want you blabbing about it to everyone in camp. Especially not Adora.”

“Ooh, it involves Adora?”

“Scorpia, drop it.”

“Catra, look…” Scorpia drew in a long breath and placed a claw on Catra’s shoulder. “I’ve really, really been taking trying to better with secrets to heart! Perfuma’s been helping me become my best self and I’ve realized being an unreliable secret keeper is bad for

friendships, so I've really been working on it! So, if you want to talk, I promise that I won't tell anyone. And that's a scorpion promise!"

Catra raised an eyebrow. "And that's different from a normal promise because…?"

"Well…because I'm a scorpion?"

"Ugh. Fine. Look, you have to *swear* you won't say anything. To anybody. Not Swift Wind, Not Sea Hawk, not Perfuma and *definitely* not Adora. Okay?"

"I swear. Force Captain's honor. Or…former Force Captain's honor. Hehe."

"Okay…" Catra groaned and dropped the hunk of scrap she was holding. "Scorpia…have you and Perfuma…you know…done it yet?"

"Done it? Like sex? Oh…oh gosh no. We're taking things slow so… we only had our second official date a couple days ago. I want to work on myself as a person before we get into a serious relationship, you know? Not that there would be anything wrong with doing anything after a second date but…"

Catra sighed. "Well, do you have any…past experience with that sort of thing?"

"With sex? Oh sure. Loads. I had tons of girlfriends back in the Horde but it never ended up working out for some reason. Maybe I was too clingy? So I started focusing on my career and then I made Force Captain and I was too busy to meet anyone and you know how it is? Married to your career and all. Haha."

"Right. Okay so. Adora and I are gonna. You know. We're gonna have sex for the first time and I…look. I don't know what I'm doing. Adora's the first person I've ever even kissed. I have no idea where to even start."

“Aww, so you’re nervous?”

“No way! I just need. You know. Some pointers, or whatever. So I don’t flounder out there like a moron and ruin the whole thing.”

“Well, I always try to use my mouth for everything. I guess I kinda have to, I mean…pincers.” Scorpia clacked her claws a few times for dramatic effect. “It’s hard to even hold hands with these things, but I manage. And uh…let’s see. Try asking a lot of questions, just make sure she’s having a good time, and if she isn’t then try something different and oh! Make sure to compliment her a lot and…is this helping?”

“Maybe?” Catra took a deep breath and let it out slowly. “But what if she hates it? What if I’m bad at it and she never wants to do it again?”

“Well gosh Catra, you two love each other. So there’s really no way to be bad at it. I think as long as you talk to each other and figure out what each other like then it’ll be fine. When it isn’t just a random fling with a teammate in the locker or some girl you meet at an outpost…when it’s somebody you really care about… well, it doesn’t really even matter what you do. It’s more about how you sort of…connect. It’s about being close. And gosh, when it’s the right person, it’s just the most romantic thing there ever was. You’ll do great, I promise.”

“Okay.” Despite the fact that most of Scorpia’s advice consisted of rambling on about intangible concepts that Catra didn’t exactly know how to implement and oversharing about the circumstances of her past sexual experiences there was some genuinely valuable information there as well, and somehow some of the nervousness in her chest loosened. Whether it was from having some small inkling of how to proceed or from simply confiding in her best friend, Catra felt lighter than she had before. “Hey Scorpia… thanks.”

Scorpia beamed. “Of course!” without warning she scooped Catra up for a hug and Catra shrieked in surprise. The two of them were

starting to attract the attention of the Rebellion members nearby, and Scorpia laughed sheepishly as Catra fixed her with a firm glare.

"Scorpia. Put me down."

"Sorry, sorry!" Scorpia placed Catra carefully on the ground and brushed imaginary dirt from her outfit with her claws. "Personal space, I know."

Scorpia was just so…authentically Scorpia, and Catra couldn't help smiling. When she awkwardly went in for a more subdued hug with her feet planted mercifully on solid ground this time, Scorpia returned the gesture wholeheartedly.

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As soon as Glimmer disappeared with a rush of sparkles and left Catra and Adora standing in the foyer of Bright Moon palace, the pressures and bustle of the day disappeared. The immediate shift from the noisy merriment of the Rebellion campsite to the stillness of the palace was a stark and physical reminder of why they were there in the first place, and Adora's cheeks blazed so hot she briefly worried they might be glowing.

Now that it was the two of them Adora was suddenly very aware of her body. The pounding of her heart echoed in her ears and made it difficult to even think as she and Catra began the journey back to their bedroom. The only distraction from how uncomfortably real and overstimulating everything felt was the warm press of Melog against her leg and she was grateful for such an anchor. She placed a hand on top of Melog's head and its warmth grounded her. Catra hadn't wanted to leave Melog behind when they returned to the palace, and as apprehensive as she'd been about the idea of another living soul knowing their intimate plans for the night before, now she was grateful for its presence.

Now that evening was setting in and the daytime moons were beginning to set, Bright Moon palace was filled with a warm pink glow that fell from the windows lining the tops of the high walls and spilled into the corridors from ceiling to floor. When Catra and Adora finished their trek to their bedroom the pink light followed them through their doorway and settled over Catra's fur as her groan turned into a yawn.

The feline collapsed rather theatrically onto the bed that had once been Adora's, but now the two shared. The sight of her there made their plans for the night feel all the more concrete and Adora's mouth went dry all over again. There was something angelic about the way Catra looked there, reclining on the bed with her short dark hair pooled around her head. Adora found herself standing near the door and just staring at her girlfriend in awe. The spell wasn't broken until Catra rolled onto her side and caught sight of her.

"Um, what are you doing? Are you just gonna stand there all night, or?"

"Uh…no." Adora snapped out of it and kicked off her boots. When she looked back at Catra she was laying on her stomach on the bed, chin propped up on her hand. Adora could hear her purring all the way across the room and the sound gave her sore muscles the strength to carry her to her girlfriend's side. Somehow at the end of such a long day just the sound of that purr made it all melt away to nothing. Catra was a beacon of comfort. Catra was home. Adora drifted toward her like she was reaching for a star. "Sorry. I guess I'm kinda off in my head."

The instant Adora sank to the edge of the bed Catra's tail wound around her wrist as she shuffled closer, her purr even louder up close. "Don't think I didn't notice you staring at me, Adora."

Despite the fact that Adora had most definitely been staring and that staring at her girlfriend especially on a night like this was perfectly fine and reasonable, somehow her first instinct was to shake her head quickly. There was no way to explain why her

cheeks flushed with embarrassment at the accusation. “Huh? Me? No way.”

Catra’s laugh was rough and warm and washed over Adora like water. The sound of it never failed to soothe her and the tension she hadn’t even realized she was holding in her shoulders loosened. “You’re almost as bad of a liar as you are actress.”

“Who says I’m a bad actress?” Adora of course understood that Catra was right, but that didn’t stop her from crossing her arms and frowning at her girlfriend. She wasn’t going to let a little thing like Catra being objectively right get in the way of playfully bickering with her. It was their way of flirting more often than not, and maybe to people outside their relationship it didn’t make sense as a way of showing love but to the two of them, it had been an unspoken part of their relationship since they were children. Of course it was going to make its way into their romantic relationship too.

“Everybody.” Catra didn’t miss a beat. One fang poked out over her lip when she grinned. “Everybody on Etheria.”

“There’s no way you’ve even met everyone on Etheria.” Adora stuck her tongue out at her.

“Yes I have and they all say you suck.”

“I’m gonna kick your butt if you’re not careful…” all of Adora’s cards were always on the table. It was always hard for her to hide her emotions and that went double for happy ones. In this moment the smile on her face was impossible to hold back. As nervous as she felt, their normal playful banter still put her at ease. Actually being in the moment with Catra like this felt so normal and so natural that the flashes of nervousness in Adora’s stomach were ebbing down into a soft sense of blazing anticipation.

“Like you even could. I could take you out any day of the week.”

“Take me out? Do you mean a date or murder?” Adora asked, and Catra’s sly expression said it all before her lips did.

“Both, obviously.”

“That’s it!” Adora launched herself at Catra, knocking her back onto the pillows and earning a loud shriek from Catra that dissolved into laughter when she started poking the precise spots on either side of her ribcage that never failed to send Catra into hysterics. Maybe roughhousing like this wasn’t the most romantic thing in the world, but right now somehow it felt right. Everything between them felt light and playful.

“Okay! Okay not fair! Quit it! Cut it out!”

“No way! I can’t believe you threatened to murder me!”

“Well if I did murder you then you wouldn’t be able to torture me anymore so maybe I should have done it when I had the chance!”

“Is that really something you should be saying when I’ve got you in this position?”

“Who cares? I’m not even ticklish anyway!” Catra insisted, though there were tears in her eyes from laughing too hard and she was squirming away from Adora with everything she had. Unfortunately for her, Adora had the upper hand.

“Oh yeah?” it was Adora’s turn to grin slyly, her fingertips still digging into Catra’s ribs. “Are you sure?”

“Ugh, I hate when you get all cocky like this.”

“No you don’t.” Adora said it in a singsong voice. “You love it. Don’t even try to pretend.”

“No, I hate it.”

“If you admit you love it I’ll stop.”

“Now you’re resorting to blackmail? I guess you can take the girl out of the Horde but not the Horde out of the girl.”

“That’s right.” Adora was enjoying herself far too much to show her girlfriend mercy. The way her cheeks flushed when she laughed this much was far too cute for her to stop until Catra gave in. “What’ll it be?”

“Fine, I love it. Ugh, you are officially the worst person alive.”

“Maybe. But you love me.” True to her word, Adora retracted her hands from Catra’s sides just in time to be startled by a plaintive meow from beside the bed. Melog’s concerned expression was visible from not even a foot away. Instantly, Adora felt bad. Of course Melog would be worried they were actually fighting; it wasn’t fully used to Etherian society yet as it was and Catra and Adora had never exactly been what might be considered the standard for interactions. She’d briefly forgotten Melog was even here.

“I’m sorry, Melog. We’re just playing, okay? Nobody is actually gonna get murdered.”

“Yet,” Catra growled. Her expression was something between a forced scowl and a poorly disguised smile. “I can’t believe you’d use that spot against me. What are we, seven years old?”

“Well, if we were I think defeating Horde Prime would have been a lot more impressive.”

Melog placed its paws on the edge of the bed and craned its neck to nuzzle against Adora’s upper arm in a gesture of understanding, and with her hands newly unoccupied she moved her hand to stoke the top of its head.

It was truly impossible to explain the sensation of Melog’s coat using only Etherian words. It was an alien being whose texture was unlike anything of Etheria. Being an alien herself, sometimes it made Adora wonder why she looked and felt so similar to a standard Etherian, knowing there were beings like Melog out

there. And yet, Melog purred loudly at being petted in a way that was so authentically feline it was easy to forget it was actually a powerful sentient magic being with the power to shift forms at will and not just an extremely large housecat.

"Sorry we worried you. Everything is okay. Sometimes Catra and I just like to mess around like this. We would never actually hurt each other."

Melog gave Adora another approving nuzzle before retreating back to the floor. Despite not being able to decipher it meows the way Catra could, Adora was pleased that she was usually able to understand what Melog meant from its gestures.

"Hey Melog, think you could give us some privacy?" Catra asked, and Melog meowed in response, rearing back onto the bed to give Catra a nuzzle too before it padded over to the bedroom door and let itself out, likely to curl up in its favorite spot on the sofa in the parlor near the warmth of the fireplace.

"Sometimes I think Melog likes you more than it likes me," Catra remarked as soon as they were alone, and Adora grinned.

"Jealous?"

"No way. Like I'd ever be jealous of your lame ass," Catra replied, but she was smiling up at her. Despite the careless and playful nature of her reply, the look the two of them shared in that moment was enough to make Adora's knees weak. Since their first kiss at the Heart they had been prone to intense, intimate moments of simply gazing into each other's eyes and whenever Adora found herself on the other end of a look like that from Catra she couldn't help wanting a repeat of that moment.

Careful not to dig her elbow into Catra's ribs when she shifted to support herself on it, Adora leaned down and pressed her forehead to her girlfriend's. "Can I kiss you?" she asked her softly.

"I told you you don't have to ask every time," Catra reminded her.

"I know. But I like asking." Adora was still barely able to comprehend that all of this was real. Having that spoken confirmation that Catra wanted her as much as she wanted Catra provided a sense of much needed certainty and besides, sometimes she just liked to hear it.

"Okay weirdo. You can kiss me. Actually, you'd *better* kiss me or I'm gonna get really impatient really quick and then I really *will* murder you."

"Promise?"

"Ugh. Can you quit it and just kiss me already?"

"Sorry. I just like seeing you get flustered." Adora moved to press a kiss to Catra's forehead before moving to her lips. Almost immediately Catra reciprocated, twining her fingers through Adora's ponytail as her lips melted into the kiss, soft and pliant and so willing to show the tenderness Catra still sometimes had trouble verbalizing.

Normally, their kissing started slow and leisurely but there was a new sense of urgency between them tonight. And of course, it wasn't as though Adora didn't understand why. There was a flash of something entirely different from nervousness that rushed through her belly and sent a flare of heat between her legs when Catra parted her lips slightly. Even such a small token of passion was enough to make her heart start to pound again.

Maybe it was the nature of this night, the conversation earlier, the unspoken intent behind each and every brush of Catra's lips, but Adora found herself unraveling in a way she never had before. The two melted closer together, Adora lowering herself to rest on her forearms so each angle of their bodies could press against one another. The heat of Catra's body was as comforting as it was exhilarating and the familiar way they fit together tonight blazed with a new kind of heat that had never been present in their makeouts before.

The two of them had fit together like this dozens of times by now, but tonight with their intentions laid bare and the castle so well and truly empty aside from the distant palace guards, there was an entirely different air about it. The neediness of Catra's tongue against her lips and in her mouth and the way she kneaded her claws so desperately into Adora's scalp sparked up a kind of fervor in her she'd never imagined she could feel.

Her heart was starting to pound all over again and their kisses went from tender and passionate to sloppy and careless and Adora wondered if Catra's own building arousal was distracting her from being able to focus on kissing properly as much as Adora's own was. Catra's hands wandered up to Adora's chest and even through her jacket and shirt the stimulation was intense. Adora was wound up and needy and the noise that broke through her lips, muffled by Catra's mouth, would have embarrassed her if she was thinking clearly.

In the past, when they touched each other like this as they made out, there was a wandering, noncommittal embarrassment that stopped their hands from lingering for too long but tonight Catra's hands cupped Adora's breasts firmly and with purpose. She caressed them slowly and there was a very palpable hunger in the way her shaking hands touched and squeezed her there.

Catra pushed Adora's jacket open, hands wandering desperately inside to cup her breasts through her shirt. Without the jacket in the way Catra was able to find Adora's nipples through the fabric surprisingly quickly and Adora gasped softly. Without even really thinking she ground her hips down against Catra and the relief at the feeling of stimulation when her pelvis connected with Catra's tore a filthy moan Adora hadn't even realized she was capable of from her throat.

The two of them ground their hips together clumsily in an uncontrolled, desperate rhythm and the sweat that was already starting to bead when they pressed their foreheads together made Catra's bangs and the bits of hair that were starting to escape from Adora's hair poof stick together. Their mouths were still

touching but Adora would hardly call it kissing at this point because they were so distracted that it was really just open mouths absentmindedly seeking each other out.

The uncoordinated grinding of her clothed sex against Catra's wasn't enough stimulation to come and it was slightly frustrating in that respect but it was still so *good* that it didn't matter. Adora was seeing stars and planets and whole galaxies behind her closed lids because the way it felt to grind together this way was just too incredible for words. Adequate stimulation or no, the contact was turning Adora on so much that she could barely form coherent thought, much less find the words to ask for more. Luckily, Catra was able to do it for her.

"I wanna get naked," Catra told her breathlessly, her mouth still half pressed to Adora's.

"M'kay…" Excitement flashing through her belly, Adora sat up and Catra immediately wriggled out from under her. The speed with which Catra's clothes ended up in a heap on the floor was so impressive that it made the way Adora was fumbling with her own belt just that much more embarrassing. Catra slid it off her easily and between the two of them her jacket and shirt ended up alongside Catra's clothes in record time.

Adora unfortunately had to slide out of bed and stand up to be able to effectively get her pants off but it also gave her the opportunity to admire Catra's naked body for a beat longer than she otherwise would have been able to. She'd seen Catra naked many times. Growing up together in the Horde it was impossible not to with communal showers and changing areas in the locker room being a part of their daily routines. However, she had never seen Catra naked like *this*. Here she was, in Adora's bed with her chest rising and falling rapidly from the arousal Adora knew she herself was responsible for. Her hair was a mess, her tail was flicking impatiently, and her chest was flushed, visible even though her fur.

Adora only had a moment to be nervous all over again before Catra grew more impatient. "Come *here*," she growled. "Are you just gonna stand there looking at me or are you gonna fuck me already?" her cheeks flushed to match her chest.

The choice of words was certainly less romantic than it could have been, but somehow the vulgarity of it excited Adora even more. She fell back into bed with enthusiasm and Catra's lips found hers again. This time, Catra's bare breasts pressed to Adora's and the sensation was almost too much to bear. Once again the two of them kissed softly and passionately but it took even less time for their kisses to become messy and needy now that they were naked. The entire energy between them felt different, molten hot in a way that took Adora's breath away.

Catra straddled Adora's thigh, still kissing her as her hand found her naked breast this time, her other hand gripping Adora's shoulder for support. Softly but desperately she cupped the full mass of Adora's breast and she massaged it somewhat clumsily at first. Adora gasped into her mouth and her hand found Catra's hip, supporting her with that arm as her other hand wandered up and down Catra's back, exploring her soft fur mindlessly. Her fingertips wove through a patch of thicker fur at the small of Catra's back and froze when Catra's fingers began to play with her nipple. The hand on Catra's hip clenched and unclenched absentmindedly as Catra explored her breasts, rolling her nipples between her fingertips off and on.

As the two continued to kiss messily and Catra's hand wandered over Adora's breasts, Catra began grinding herself on Adora's thigh. It seemed like it was almost unconscious, and the wetness of Catra's sex and the way it left a slick spot on her thigh made Adora's heart pound even harder than it already was.

There was something so enthralling about watching Catra fuck her thigh like this that Adora just froze and pulled back from kissing her to watch her. The two's eyes locked, and Catra's hand froze on Adora's breast. For a few intense and unbelievably attractive moments the only motion in the room was Catra grinding herself

against Adora's thigh and the loud purr that rose in Catra's throat filled the silence in a way that was so mesmerizing Adora wondered if it was possible to just stay in this moment forever.

Without warning, Catra moved from her thigh and lay down on the bed, grabbing Adora's hand and pulling her with her. As soon as Catra arranged the blanket over them the two settled in to lie on their sides facing each other, mouths seeking each other out immediately and clashing together a bit harder than they should have. Their teeth clacked together briefly before they sorted things out.

As their kisses went from cautious to desperate almost immediately this time Adora reached out to grasp Catra's hip, massaging it gently before tracing her fingertips up her body to her chest. When her hand cupped Catra's breast for the first time Catra made a tiny 'mm' sound into Adora's mouth and Adora's heart hammered so hard behind her ribs that her head swam and her limbs all felt weak at once. The softness and heat of Catra's breast in her hand was unreal. This all had to be a dream. There could be no way she was actually lying in bed with Catra touching her like this, exploring her breasts and nipples as the two of them kissed in a frenzied hungry way that felt just spiked her blood even more.

But it was real. Adora knew it had to be. The warm heat of Catra against her, the wetness of her mouth and the pounding of her heart that she found she could feel when she pressed in the right spot on her breast anchored her to the reality of this moment and Adora found herself humbled. Despite everything—or perhaps because of everything—the two had gone through to be able to end up at each other's side here they were. It was as incredible as it was difficult to believe, and Adora wouldn't change a thing about this night.

Letting her hand wander down Catra's stomach in the space between their bodies, Adora's nervousness returned but the weight of it was infinitely lighter under the intense heat of her arousal. What Glimmer hadn't told her was that it would be much

harder to fall prey to her nervousness and awkwardness that had plagued her earlier when they were in the heat of the moment. The way Catra kissed her made it so, so clear how much she wanted this in a way even her asking Adora point blank if she wanted to sleep with her hadn't and all of Adora's uncertainty was nothing in the face of her all-encompassing desire to make Catra feel good.

Adora's hand paused just within the first few centimeters of Catra's pubic hair. She was all too aware of her fingers shaking as she parted her lips from Catra's just enough to speak. "Can I touch you?" she asked softly.

Catra nodded. "Yeah," she whispered. The intimacy of this moment was unreal. This was the part she hadn't been able to imagine when she tried to map her battle plan for tonight out in her head. The soft glow of Catra's eyes in the dim pink light of evening burned right down into her soul and Adora knew this would be something she would remember for the rest of her life. "Touch me."

Adora tried to press each sensation into her memory to keep forever. The wiry texture of Catra's pubic hair and the heat of her as she clumsily slid her fingers between the folds of Catra's labia and touched her for the first time. Catra gasped into her mouth and pulled back to rest her forehead to Adora's as Adora's fingertips cautiously explored. She didn't really know what she was doing, and she hoped it wasn't glaringly obvious how uncertain she was about how to make this feel good.

Adora had only ever touched herself here before and even then she'd never really bothered to think about what exactly she was doing. It was much easier when she had the instant feedback loop of masturbating. When it was Catra, suddenly even anatomy that she herself possessed felt so foreign to her and there just seemed to be so many layers of folds. What if she couldn't find Catra's clit? What if she fumbled around down here for so long Catra wasn't turned on anymore? The thought flustered her. Touching Catra felt incredible but what mattered more to Adora was making it feel

incredible to *Catra*. Suddenly her perceived inadequacies from earlier didn't seem only perceived.

'Communicate' was the advice Glimmer gave her, and Adora tried to take it to heart.

"Sorry," she mumbled. "Is this okay? I don't really know what I'm doing so I hope this is okay."

"I like it," Catra told her breathlessly. She shifted her leg a bit and Adora found the extra space the new position offered made it easier to feel around. "It feels good."

"Even if I haven't found the right spot yet?"

"Yeah. It still feels good. It's you touching me, so…" Catra moved in for a long, deep kiss. "I've been fantasizing about you touching me for years."

"Really?" Adora's heart leaped.

"Really. I used to pretend it was you touching me every time I did it myself. I don't care if I don't get off. I just…want this. I wanna feel you touching me, and you are. So it's okay, really."

"Wow…" Adora was emboldened by Catra's admission. "Okay. Thanks. Sorry for worrying so much."

"You always worry this much. It's okay."

"Will you tell me when I find it?"

"Uh-huh."

Satisfied with having communicated properly, she kissed Catra again. Their kisses were a little slower this time but it didn't take long to fall back into sloppy and uncontrolled kissing and when one of Adora's fingertips made contact with Catra's clit her mouth fell from Adora's and her forehead collided with Adora's just a little too hard. Her claws dug into Adora's shoulder.

Before she touched it Adora had been starting to worry she wouldn't know when she found Catra's clit, but her immediate reaction and how different the little nub felt from the skin around it proved those thoughts wrong.

"Right there," Catra whispered, though her reaction made it obvious enough she didn't need to verbalize. Adora touched it again, centering her fingertip over the spot and starting to rub it enthusiastically. Catra jerked a bit at first and then settled, a soft moan rising up in her throat. She'd been purring the entire time, but as Adora stroked her there the volume intensified.

"Is this okay?" Adora asked quickly. She was watching Catra's face carefully for any hint she might give away of what was right and what was wrong. "Do you need anything different?"

"I…uh…maybe a little slower?" Catra asked. Her voice was soft and there was vulnerability to it that made Adora want to protect her forever. She calmed her pace a little, rubbing Catra's clit slower and trying to keep a steady pace. Catra's reaction was a long, low moan that broke off into a growl and Adora made sure not to change a thing as she continued to rub the tip of her finger up and down over the sensitive bundle of nerves.

The feeling of stimulating Catra in such an intimate way took Adora's breath away and she had to shift her leg so her thighs weren't pressing together anymore. Even that amount of pressure was threatening to send her over the edge while she was touching Catra like this. She didn't want to come like this; she wanted to focus on Catra.

In this moment, the soft sound of Catra's breath coming in huffs and the heat of her in her hand encompassed her focus completely. It was stunning to realize she could feel the thudding of Catra's heartbeat in her clit and she tried to match the way she touched her to the rhythm of her heartbeat, because it gave her a concrete way to keep up a pace that would feel good.

“You feel so good,” Adora found herself whispering, unable to keep her thoughts to herself, and when Catra opened her eyes and her gaze met Adora’s, the universe centered in on Catra all over again and Adora was stricken deeply and irreversibly with the knowledge that she would never give up this woman for anything. She would give her life for even one more moment at her side if it ever came down to it. To Adora in this moment Catra was the moon and the stars and every distant galaxy and more. She was all she could ever want, and she was all hers.

“Adora…” Catra’s voice was breathless and fraught with emotion. The softness of Catra’s tail winding around the wrist of the hand she was using to get her off was so intimate and so beautiful to her that she forgot how to breathe.

The two of them locked eyes for a long, quiet moment before Catra’s lips crashed into Adora’s, a messy and lazy kiss that didn’t seem sustainable when Catra was breathing this hard. She was briefly distracted long enough that her fingertip slipped from Catra’s clit but she fumbled to touch it again, and this time she unintentionally pushed her finger up a little higher under the skin of the hood and when she stimulated the very top of Catra’s clit this time she whimpered in a way Adora had never heard before. It was enough to make her freeze.

“Are you okay?”

“Yeah that just feels…really good. It’s almost too good? It’s a lot.”

“Should I stop?”

“No! No just…be careful. It’s really really sensitive there.”

“Okay.” Adora was determined to do this right, and this time she rubbed much gentler, trying to apply as little pressure as possible. Catra squeezed her shoulder tighter and her claws threatened to break the skin, but Adora didn’t mind. This was just another unexpected benefit of having healing powers. If Catra ended up accidentally hurting her she could just fix it up later like it never

happened, so she could just let Catra fall apart as completely as she needed to. She would never need to hold back when she was with Adora. "Is this okay?"

It took Catra a moment to even respond. Her eyes were open but out of focus, and she wasn't looking at Adora. She didn't seem to be looking at much of anything. "Yeah," she whispered breathlessly. "That's really good it's…don't stop. Don't stop…"

"I won't," Adora promised, building up a gentle rhythm. Catra squirmed a little, her hips shaking. Her clit gave a few tiny jerks under Adora's touch, and she wondered if it was a good or a bad thing before breathy moans started escaping Catra's mouth. She was purring louder than Adora had ever heard at this point, her hips giving tiny seemingly involuntary twitches.

When she was trying to plot out the logistics for this night earlier, Adora had been trying to figure out how she would know Catra came, but it turned out she didn't need to wonder. Catra stretched out in a hard spasm, a sound that vacillated between a moan and a growl leaving her lips as she crushed her mouth to Adora's but it was barely a kiss, just her tongue lashing desperately against hers as she trembled through her orgasm. If the world fell apart right now Adora wouldn't care. The sight of Catra coming was so beautiful it bordered on spiritual and Adora was caught in the tide of her girlfriend's pleasure in a way she never wanted to escape from.

Even after Catra went limp and the moans died in her throat, Adora kept stroking her clit until it stopped giving tiny periodic twitches.

"Are you done?" she asked when Catra fell completely still, wanting to make sure she was able to enjoy herself fully. Catra nodded silently and only then did Adora draw her hand away. She hadn't noticed before that her wrist was sore. Now it was more obvious but she didn't want to massage her aching joints it right now. All she wanted to do was stare at Catra.

“Was that okay?” she asked as Catra caught her breath.

“That was more than okay,” Catra assured her, giving her a soft kiss. “That was amazing.” She sat up and Adora couldn’t help feeling a little embarrassed when Catra’s eyes roved up and down her body. “Is it okay if I make you come too?”

That was like asking if she wanted to breathe air. “Well, yeah but…only if you want to. I touched you because I wanted to. I don’t want you to feel like you have to just because I did.”

“Oh, Adora.” Catra reached out and pushed the blanket off Adora fully, exposing her entire body. “You have no idea how bad I want to.” The rough rumble of her voice reminded Adora all over again how turned on she was. She’d been so focused on getting Catra off she’d almost forgotten about her own body and now she was reminded of the intense, almost painful throb of arousal between her legs.

“Roll onto your back, okay?” Catra asked, and Adora obeyed as quickly as she could. Catra leaned forward and ran her hands up and down her torso slowly, stopping to caress her breasts and nipples again. Adora moaned softly before she could stop herself and when she cut if off mid sound, Catra’s expression softened.

“It’s okay to make noise,” Catra promised, she voice so gentle Adora melted. “I wanna hear you. You don’t have to be embarrassed. Besides, there’s nobody here tonight. You might as well take advantage of that.”

The warmth that rushed into Adora’s cheeks matched the warmth in her heart perfectly. “Okay,” she agreed awkwardly with a nod. Catra’s fingertips fondled her breasts gently and when she started to play with her nipples again in the same way she had earlier, Adora let another tiny moan escape.

“I wanna use my mouth on you,” Catra told her gently. “Is that okay?”

Adora's heart raced at the thought, another pang of arousal rushing through her. "On my boobs?" she asked, and the sly grin on Catra's face just made it even more intense.

"Well yeah," Catra replied seductively, and the tone of her voice drove Adora insane in the most delicious way possible. "But not *just* your boobs?"

"You mean you wanna…?"

"Yeah. I really, really do. If you're okay with that."

Adora lifted her head a bit and nodded so hard her ponytail whipped around. "Yeah! I'm totally okay with that. But I didn't shower or anything. What if…what if I taste gross?"

"You won't," Catra promised. She shifted to take Adora's hair tie between two fingers and snap it with her claws. "There. You should be relaxing. Just trust me."

"I do," Adora assured her. Her own voice sounded so soft and vulnerable she almost didn't recognize it.

"Good. I love you."

"I love you too…"

Catra leaned down and pressed her lips to Adora's breast, peppering it with kisses before she flicked her tongue over one nipple. The heat of her mouth made Adora jerk a bit without meaning to, and this time she let her soft gasp turn into a moan when Catra took it between her lips and lashed her tongue over it repeatedly. She then let go and moved to her other breast, repeating her tongue's attention on each nipple and alternating back and forth.

Adora was starting to find it hard to breathe and she couldn't help squirming. Her arousal was starting to become too much to bear. The throb between her legs was almost painful and she had never been quite so aware of her own clit. From the sensation of Catra's

mouth on her chest, Adora couldn't help imagining what it might feel like there too, and just the imagined sensation was almost enough to make her come completely untouched.

"Catra…" she whispered. Adora had never been very good at asking for what she wanted, but right now she couldn't let that hold her back, because she was so needy that it almost felt like her body was hungry. It was something she'd never experienced before, and the heat of it threatened to consume her completely. It was difficult to even express, how the thought of coming in Catra's mouth nearly made her want to cry. She'd been turned on in the past, often turned on enough to touch herself, but it had never felt like a *need*. Until tonight Adora didn't know she could even *be* this horny. She'd never known it could feel like this, painful and achingly burningly hot and frustrating beyond belief but somehow still so, so good.

"Catra…" she gasped again, this time finally finding the words. "Please I…wow. It's too much. I can't take any more or I might… you know." It was all she could do to keep from pressing her thighs together and finally finding sweet release.

Catra lifted her head from Adora's chest and made eye contact. The expression on her face was one of sheer wonder. "Are you saying you might come from me sucking on your nipples?" Catra sounded mesmerized, and a pleased smile spread over her face. "Adora…wow."

"This is all a lot!" Adora reminded her defensively, and Catra smiled at her.

"No, I wasn't making fun of you or anything. I think that's really hot." Catra kissed a trail down her stomach, and Adora's abs jerked unconsciously at the touch. She was so overstimulated that any kind of contact at all was almost too much.

By the time Catra finally settled herself between Adora's legs, her thighs were shaking . Catra placed a few kisses on the trembling limbs before she moved to just stare between Adora's legs. Adora

watched her in fascination. She was nearly completely overcome by sheer embarrassment when Catra spread her open with her fingers, and the rush of air on her most intimate parts felt cold though it was warm in the room. Adora suppressed a shudder.

"You smell nice," Catra promised. She started by gently licking Adora's outer lips before her tongue wandered inward, exploring every part of her instead of where Adora desperately longed to be touched. The heat of her tongue, the soft wetness of it…it was too much.

It was incredible and too much and not enough and when Catra did finally focus the attention of that wonderful tongue on Adora's clit all it took was a few glorious licks before Adora came undone. She cried out, shuddering and trembling, and squirming against Catra's mouth as her orgasm ripped through her. Catra licked her indulgently until she stopped trembling and the climax came in waves that were so intense but also so achingly short that Adora was left wanting more when she finally settled down.

"Adora…wow," Catra whispered, her mouth still only inches from Adora's sex.

"I told you," Adora reminded her, her breathing ragged. "Remember?"

"Well yeah but…I didn't realize how serious it was." She paused for a moment, and when she made eye contact Adora flushed. "Hey, Adora…have you ever gotten off twice before?"

"You mean like…by myself?"

"Yeah. Like, twice at once?"

"I mean…yeah, a couple times?" A rush of excitement overtook her. "Why?"

"Can I keep going? I feel like I barely got to get started."

"Yeah. Please."

Catra lowered her head and licked Adora's clit again, slow and deliberate. Adora gasped and pushed her hips closer to her. She was still incredibly sensitive, now even more so from her orgasm, and the sensation of that warm tongue stimulating her again was as intense as it was wonderful. She moaned softly as Catra flicked her tongue over her clit again and again. A purr started to rumble in Catra's throat and vibrated through her tongue, just adding another layer of pleasure to the way it felt to be licked like this by her after such an incredible amount of buildup.

"You taste great," Catra told her between licks. Adora didn't expect something like that to turn her on even more, but it did.

"Thanks," she stammered.

Catra was laser focused on Adora's clit with featherlight flicks of the tip of her tongue, and as good as it felt, it was tickling a bit in a way that was distracting. Adora didn't want to stop Catra, or to make her think she wasn't doing a good job, but she thought again about Glimmer's advice about communication, and she cleared her throat.

"I think I need a little more pressure," she told Catra shakily. "Can you…try something different?"

"Yeah…here…" Catra shifted her weight a bit and dragged her tongue a littler firmer against Adora's clit. Adora moaned softly at the increased stimulation, and Catra repeated it a few times.

"Oh…" Adora gasped. Absentmindedly, her hands gripped at the pillow under her head. "That feels good, yeah…like that I think. Woah. Yeah. That's it, definitely. *Just* like that. Thanks." She was aware that maybe thanking Catra right now was ridiculous, but she didn't care. All she cared about was the way that perfect tongue was stoking her clit with slow, deliberate licks that made her see stars.

Catra purred harder at Adora's words and she moved her hands up to hold Adora's hips. Somehow it felt even better now that

Catra wasn't spreading her open, like her tongue was able to cover her clit more completely. She could feel Catra's lips against her now as her tongue kept stroking insistently at her in a way that for this brief moment made it feel like the entirety of the world started and ended with her clit.

Adora had never imagined stimulation could feel like this. Of course Catra's mouth was infinitely better than her own hand but it went beyond that. When she masturbated it was purely mechanical, a way to scratch an itch and ease frustration caused by her basest instincts. But this was something more, something beautiful and complete. The closest thing she could compare it to was the way the two of them had danced together at Princess Prom. A meeting of two bodies in an intricate ritual.

Nothing could have prepared Adora for sex being something so far beyond physical. In these moments, Adora felt vulnerable and bared to the world, but she also felt safe. Infinitely so. Catra's hands on her hips held her gently like she might break, and she held her together in a cradle of safety as she fell apart more and more. She had never felt closer to Catra than she did right now, like Catra held the whole world together for her so she didn't have to carry its weight herself.

Those deliberate and focused strokes of Catra's tongue dragged Adora up to the stars and sent her crashing back down to Etheria when the sensations in her clit increased, when her body grew hotter and hotter and her heart pounded so fast she was worried it might give out. This time her orgasm came slower, creeping in bit by bit and easing her toward more and more complete stimulation in a way that frustrated her, because she could feel it coming and she wanted it so desperately but it always seemed just another inch away.

And yet, Catra in all her wild and rough impatience was patient with Adora in this intimate moment that seemed to last forever. She licked her diligently even when Adora worried she would stay locked in this limbo forever and when the first bright flashes of Adora's orgasm flickered through her it was like Catra could feel it.

She dug her claws lightly into Adora's skin where her hands rested on her hips, and that just pushed Adora over the edge even more.

With each insistent, patient stoke of Catra's tongue the pleasure built higher and higher until Adora couldn't take it anymore. She was so lost in the pleasure and blissed out completely that it was almost too much. But was it enough? Could it ever be enough? It was enough. It was too much. Its intensity scared her and humbled her and she never wanted it to end.

The moans that crashed from Adora's mouth in a dangerously loud cacophony didn't even sound like her own. She didn't think she was capable of making sounds like that. The blinding heat of Adora's orgasm was white, piercing white that blazed like a bright light and pulsed through her clit like nothing else. No one could have ever described to her what a complete orgasm in Catra's mouth felt like in a million years and now that she was experiencing it her whole body felt like it might smash into pieces again and again.

She jerked her hips against Catra's face as she lost herself in it completely and just let go. There was a beauty in the catharsis of letting go and Catra was there for her for each blinding second, taking her clit between her lips and rolling her tongue in rough circles over it as she drew ragged moans from Adora's throat until she had nothing to give. With a rough gasp her hips collapsed still onto the bed beneath her and all her muscles relaxed at once. She hadn't even realized she'd been tensed until now, and the absolute peace that rushed through her was like nothing she'd ever felt. Never in her life could Adora remember being this relaxed.

"Woah…" she gasped. Catra's tongue gave her one final stoke before retreating and Catra sat up, wiping her mouth with the back of her hand. There was still more of Adora's slick on Catra's chin, and she was so blissed out she couldn't be embarrassed. It was just a simple fact that it was there, and it glistened faintly there in the fading pink light.

Catra crawled up to her, leaning down to give her a kiss and Adora was briefly horrified, then excited, that she could taste herself.

"Good?" Catra asked her, though Adora had a suspicion Catra knew she didn't have to ask.

"Uh, yeah. Good doesn't even begin to describe what you just did," Adora told her breathlessly. Her voice sounded strange and rough, and she realized it was probably because of how hoarse her throat felt. "Oh. Was I loud?"

"Yeah," Catra replied. She kissed her forehead. "It was hot as hell. We might have to keep it down when people are here in the future but I'm glad you could cut loose tonight. You know I…never mind."

"What?"

"Never mind. You'll be embarrassed."

"Well now you have to tell me."

"Well…you made sounds kinda like that when we fought sometimes. Like, on the battlefield. If I didn't know any better I'd think you were getting off on me clawing you then, too."

Adora was indignant. "I was not!"

"Well you didn't seem to mind my claws tonight," Catra purred. One hand reached down to caress her hip gently. Adora looked down to see faint marks there. "Sorry. I guess I went a little too far maybe." There was a shadow of guilt in her voice.

"No, it was perfect," Adora assured her quickly. For a moment, the two were silent, and Adora sat up and wrapped her arms around her girlfriend. The sweat of their bodies made the contact sticky, but she couldn't bring herself to mind. Catra collapsed into her readily, and her purr was even louder now that it had been in the moments before when they were entangled in passion.

“I don’t know about perfect. I didn’t really know what I was doing. Like, at all. I was so sure I was gonna screw it up.”

Adora’s heart melted. “Me too! I was so nervous I asked Glimmer for advice because I had no idea what to even do! But you didn’t screw it up at all, I promise! You were amazing!”

“You were amazing,” Catra deflected. “And I uh…asked Scorpia for advice. I was nervous too.”

“You didn’t have any reason to be.” Adora realized now it applied to both of them. “I love you. No matter how it went, it was going to be perfect because it was you.”

“Because it was us,” Catra corrected, and Adora ran a hand slowly up and down her sweaty back. It hadn’t occurred to her how nervous Catra probably was too. She was so beautiful and she had oozed so much confidence when she’d asked Adora if she wanted tonight in the first place that somehow the true reality of it has escaped her until now. But now, Catra seemed so small and so vulnerable that she couldn’t help drawing her closer and peppering kisses over her sweaty hair.

“I love you so much,” she whispered between kisses, and Catra’s purr picked up even more.

“I love you too, Adora.”

For a few beautiful moments in the fading light, the two held each other. Their breathing slowed and synched, and it felt that they no longer inhabited two spaces on Etheria, but one. Adora got lost in the smell of Catra, the feeling of her in her arms. The reality that she was her girlfriend and that tonight was only the first of many and that they would be able to learn each other’s bodies, to gain confidence and memorize what each other liked and someday pleasing each other would be second nature. As excited as she was for knowing each other’s bodies so well, she was just as excited for the process of learning.

“So, how long do you wanna wait before we go again?” Catra asked her playfully, and Adora snapped back to reality, laughing warmly and pulling back from their hug.

“Hmmm…maybe we should go to the bathroom first. And maybe a snack?”

“Sounds good,” Catra agreed. “I guess Sparkles isn’t coming to get us until morning, right? We have the rest of the night.”

Something Glimmer had said in their earlier conversation ran through Adora’s head, and she couldn’t help smiling.

“We have the rest of our lives.”

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